

Sanchar Saathi Chakshu Citizen Guide for Reporting Malicious Communications

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Official Advisory: Department of Telecommunications: Chakshu Citizen Facility Guidelines

What is Chakshu Facility?

Chakshu is a citizen-centric initiative on the Sanchar Saathi portal (sancharsaathi.gov.in) developed by the Department of Telecommunications (DoT). It enables citizens to report suspected fraudulent communication received through SMS, WhatsApp, or voice calls before financial loss occurs.

Reportable Fraud Categories on Chakshu

Citizens should utilize Chakshu to report:

1. KYC expiry/deactivation warnings for bank, wallet, electricity, or telecom connections.
2. Impersonation of government officials, police, or regulatory authorities.
3. Fake lottery, cashback, reward, and gift card promotional messages.
4. Suspicious links attempting to deliver unauthorized APK packages or phishing forms.
5. Fake job offers and predatory lending promotions.

Action Taken by Telecom Operators and Law Enforcement

Once reported, DoT coordinates with telecom service providers (TSPs) to verify suspect numbers. Confirmed fraudulent numbers, SIM cards, and associated handsets (IMEIs) are blacklisted across all Indian telecom networks. Over 1 crore fraudulent mobile connections have been disconnected through this framework.

Distinction Between Chakshu and 1930 Helpline

Chakshu is designed for proactive threat intelligence and preventive blocking of fraudulent communication channels. If financial loss has already occurred, citizens MUST report directly to helpline 1930 or cybercrime.gov.in to initiate fund recovery.

Citizen Action Checklist & Red Flags

- **Verify Sender Identity:** Always check official website addresses and header IDs (e.g., VM-SBI, AX-HDFC). Scammers use fake sender masks.
- **Never Share Authentication Secrets:** Passwords, OTPs, UPI PINs, and debit card CVVs are strictly confidential. Bank staff will NEVER ask for them.
- **Independent Verification:** If you receive a threat or alert about an account freeze, call the official bank branch number found on your physical card or bank statement.
- **Immediate Reporting:** Report cyber financial fraud within the Golden Hour by calling 1930 or visiting cybercrime.gov.in.

Frequently Asked Questions (Regulatory Clarifications)

Q1: Can money be deposited into my bank account by entering my UPI PIN?

A: No. A UPI PIN is solely an authorization to debit funds from your linked bank account. Receiving funds requires NO authentication or PIN entry.

Q2: What is the first action to take if money is fraudulently deducted?

A: Dial 1930 immediately to register the complaint on the Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre (I4C) CFCFRMS portal so that the beneficiary account can be frozen before funds are withdrawn.

Q3: What should I do if an unknown caller threatens me with a police arrest over video call?

A: Disconnect immediately. Indian police and law enforcement agencies never issue summons, conduct investigations, or place citizens under 'Digital Arrest' via video calls.

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